

DAY 1 · 1 of 3

ARRIVAL & NATCHEZ EXPLORATION

No riding today — arrival day.

Arrive in Natchez — one of the oldest cities on the Mississippi River. Spend the afternoon and evening exploring before your ride begins tomorrow.

HISTORY & CONTEXT

Natchez sits on a bluff 200 feet above the Mississippi River and has been continuously inhabited for over 10,000 years. The Natchez people maintained their capital here until colonial wars in the 1730s dispersed them. By the early 1800s, Natchez had become the wealthiest city per capita in the United States — built on cotton and enslaved labor. The antebellum mansions you see today are the legacy of that era. The city was largely spared during the Civil War, preserving much of its extraordinary 19th century architecture intact.

POINTS OF INTEREST

● Natchez Bluffs & Under-the-Hill

Walk

The bluffs overlook the Mississippi — best at sunset. Under-the-Hill was once the most notorious district on the frontier.

● Stanton Hall

Tour

One of the grandest antebellum mansions in America. Tours run daily. Allow 60-90 min. Book ahead in spring.

● Longwood

Tour

An unfinished octagonal mansion — construction stopped when the Civil War began and was never resumed. Upper floors still hold the builder's tools. 4.9★

● Historic Natchez City Cemetery

Walk

Extraordinary 19th century monuments. Free, open daily. Allow 30 minutes.